

The Singing Spring

The sunlit hills of Greece roll down to a bright blue sea, dotted with olive groves, white marble columns, and little towns where everyone knows your name. High above, hidden in the clouds of Mount Olympus, the gods watch over the world, and the hills are full of wonders: riddling sphinxes, kindly centaurs, shy satyrs, and nymphs who sing by the springs. Here a hero is not the strongest or the loudest, but the one who keeps a cool head, asks good questions, and stands by a friend. The grandest deeds are done by being clever and brave and kind. Even a fearsome guardian, met with courage and a fair word, often turns out to be lonelier than it is wicked.



The Singing Spring

Read aloud, or let an older child read it themselves. Pause at each question so the heroes can decide together. There are no wrong answers here, only braver ideas to try.

Before you begin

For as long as anyone could remember, the Singing Spring had sung high in the hills, and its song had kept every well in the Olive Town cool and brimming. Then, one grey morning, the song simply stopped. The wells sank low. The olive leaves hung limp and thirsty, and the whole valley felt as if it were holding its breath.

Old Daphne, keeper of the olive grove, called the two of you to her side. "You have clever heads and kind hearts," she said, "and that is worth more up there than any sword. Will you climb the hill and wake the spring?"

Into your hands she pressed three gifts: a ball of golden thread, a honey cake wrapped in a leaf, and a small lyre worn smooth with playing. "Remember," she said, "in these hills we do not win by being the strongest. We win by being clever, brave, and kind."

What is your hero name? Which quality will you carry: Wits, Courage, or Heart?

Stop 1: The Riddle Gate

The road climbed into the sun, and at the top stood a tall gate of white marble. On its warm steps lay a sphinx, her body a lion's, her wings folded gold, her face calm and clever. She watched you with the patience of someone who has all the time in the world.

"None may pass," she said, "until they answer my riddle." There was no cruelty in it. If anything, she looked pleased to have visitors who might actually think.

Will you listen closely and puzzle it out together? A brave, thoughtful guess is welcome too. What do you try?

When your answer came, the sphinx dipped her great wings and drew the gate aside. "Well thought," she said, almost smiling, and let you through.

Stop 2: The Winding Maze

Beyond the gate the path split, and split again, into a maze of old stone walls where every turning looked exactly like the last. One wrong choice and you might wander until dark.

A goat-legged satyr swung up onto a wall, grinning. It was Bramble, who loved a traveller and a good joke in equal measure. He hummed a tune and tipped his head down one shadowed lane.

How will you keep from losing your way? You carry a ball of golden thread, and Bramble seems willing to help. What is your plan?

By tying the thread at the entrance and letting it trail behind you, every step became a step you could undo. The maze could not trap a hero with a thread, and soon you stepped out into the long golden light of evening.

Stop 3: The Lonely Giant

And there, at last, was the spring. But a giant sat squarely in front of it: one enormous eye, two folded arms, and a face set hard as the cliff behind him. Your heart thumped. He looked, for a moment, like the end of the adventure.

Then he sniffed. And you understood. He was not angry. He was lonely. No traveller had ever stayed to speak with him, and the long silence had made him gruff.

This was never a fight. What kindness could you show him? You have a honey cake to share. You could ask his name, or simply tell him that he is not alone. What do you do?

When you offered your kindness, the giant's huge eye brimmed over, and he wiped it with the back of one enormous hand. "You stayed," he whispered, as though he could hardly believe it. "You are my friends." And he shuffled, very gently, aside.

The Spring Sings Again

You stood at the edge of the quiet water and lifted the little lyre. The tune you played was simple and a touch wobbly, but it came straight from the heart, and that was all the spring had been waiting for.

The surface trembled. Up through the spray rose the Singing Nymphs, laughing, their voices weaving into a song so bright it seemed to lift the whole hillside. The spring leapt back to life, and far below, every well in the Olive Town brimmed cool and clear once more.

High on cloud-wrapped Olympus, wise Athena looked down and smiled. You had done it, and you had done it together: with your wits, with your courage, and above all with your kindness. Well done, heroes of the Sunlit Hills.

The Story in Pictures



A friendly winged sphinx on sunlit marble steps tilting her kind face, two small heroes thinking below.



Two heroes in a sunlit stone maze trailing a glowing golden thread, a cheerful satyr pointing the way.



A huge gentle one-eyed giant by a cave looking shy and sad, two small heroes offering a honey cake with kind smiles.



A clear spring bursting back to life, gentle water nymphs singing in the spray, a hero playing a little lyre as the giant smiles.

My Adventure Sheet

Draw your hero

My name

I am a hero of

My energy stars (colour one in when you spend it)



My magics



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can



My magic is

It can

What I carry

Notes

Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.

Wits and Wonder

Story Pack

<https://github.com/agigante80/wits-and-wonder>

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